



Swinburne University of Technology
Hawthorn Campus
Department of Computing Technologies

COS30015 IT Security
Assignment 2 - Semester 2, 2025

Part B Incident Situational Report

Due Date: AEST 23:59 on 02/11/2025.

Having investigated all the artefacts provided, a situation report update has been requested to understand the incident.

Compute the following template with your findings from your investigation.

COS30015 SITREP		
Impacted COS30015 Accounts	Student & Student ID	Student name: Prajeet Student ID: 105338683
<list all user accounts impacted in the incident>	Class	
	Tutor	
Incident Timeline	Impacted COS30015 Hosts	
<provide an incident timeline> On the 17 th September the admin received an email saying that it is from Ubuntu and the patch.exe file needs to be installed in the webserver. The patch file will install RAT on the webserver.	<provide a list of hosts/assets impacted and the perceived severity of this host being compromised> The Webserver was used by the attacker to initiate an attack. A fake admin account was created to gain full access of the system. The execution policy has been changed to	

The attacker will access the webserver. Then the attacker will download the “secret-information-results-password.txt” Then the attacker will leak the answers on dark web.	allow any malicious script to run. The TA account was created to steal sensitive data. The file server was illegally accessed by an authorized user.
IoCs Observed	TTPs Observed
<list all IoCs observed> e.g. - Malware Payload hash - SHA256: AAABB.... Encoded Powershell: Set-Execution Policy The university’s teaching materials were leaked on the dark web for sale	<list all TTPs observed> Observed techniques T1566.001- The phishing email that led to the execution of patch.exe. T1059.001-The decoded powershell

Suspicious commands was used to create an admin that can change the admin privileges and limit security. A phishing email was sent to the admin containing a Trojan that was installed to the web server. The system contained a malicious exe The files were accessed and downloaded by an unknown user. The server was accessed using RDP	command that was executed. T1136- The new admin user been created. T1136- The new admin account was give admin privileges T1021-Using remote services T1041- Data was exfiltrate with the use of the Curl command T1005- Downloading the secret-information-results-passwords.txt file.
Remediation Advice	
<provide remediation advice for how COS30015 should secure their systems given the TTPs observed> Limiting admin privileges: As observed from TTP due to administrative users having more privileges, they were able to access the universities resources and also limit the admin privileges. Furthermore, administrative accounts must follow a strong password policy as it limits the risk of any unauthorized users from accessing the system's data. Limiting these privileges will also reduce the risks of any accidental threats and leaking any sensitive information. Preventing initial access and execution: As observed from the TTP due to lack of network security and restricted settings the attacker accesses the server using the RDP port. To prevent this issue the system security must be regularly updated to ensure that it blocks the users from receiving any phishing emails any unnecessary access must be disabled. Containment and Eradication: The user must immediately isolate the devices that has been infected, delete any adversary created accounts, remove any malicious files and change the powershell to a more restricted setting. This prevents any authorized users from creating any new accounts to gain admin access to the system. The user must be given the tools to understand how to prevent these attacks: As observed from TTP the attacker sends a phishing by convincing the user to download the patch exe	

file on the university's web browser. To reduce this risk users must be asked to watch tutorials explaining the different types of attacks and what steps they must follow if they encounter an attack like this.

Preventing exfiltration: Implementing Data loss prevention solutions will block the attacker from stealing and sending any sensitive information like secret-information-results-passwords.txt to their external server.